BY ORDER OF THE SECRETARY OF THE AIR FORCE

DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE POLICY DIRECTIVE 10-30

4 MARCH 2025

Operations

PERSONNEL RECOVERY

COMPLIANCE WITH THIS PUBLICATION IS MANDATORY

ACCESSIBILITY: Publications and forms are available on the e-Publishing website at www.e-Publishing.af.mil for downloading or ordering

RELEASABILITY: There are no releasability restrictions on this publication

---

OPR: AF/A3S

Certified by: AF/A3 (Lt Gen Adrian L. Spain)
USSF: SF/COO (Lt Gen Deanna M. Burt, (Senior Coordinator)

Supersedes: AFPD 10-30, 28 August 2018
AFPD 16-13, 1 March 2000

Pages: 8

This publication implements Department of Defense Directive (DoDD) 3002.01, *Personnel Recovery in the Department of Defense;* Department of Defense Instruction (DoDI) 3002.02, *406 Mhz Emergency Beacons and Other Emergency Reporting Devices in the Department of Defense in Support of Personnel Recovery and Search and Rescue;* DoDI 3002.03, *DoD Personnel Recovery - Reintegration of Recovered Personnel;* DoDI 3002.04, *DoD Personnel Recovery – Non-Conventional Assisted Recovery (NAR);* DoDI O-3002.05, *Personnel Recovery (PR) Education and Training;* DoDI 2310.05, *Accounting for Missing Persons – Boards of Inquiry;* DoDI 3003.01, *DoD Support to Civil Search and Rescue (SAR)* and is consistent with Headquarters Air Force Mission Directive (HAFMD) 1-54, *Deputy Chief of Staff, Operations;* Joint Publication (JP) *3-50, Personnel Recovery;* HAFMD 1-24, *Assistant Secretary of the Air Force, Manpower and Reserve Affairs.* This directive issues overarching policy on conducting Personnel Recovery (PR) operations to maintain a global PR program. This publication applies to all civilian employees and uniformed members of the Regular Air Force, the Air Force Reserve, the Air National Guard, the United States Space Force, the Civil Air Patrol when conducting missions as the official Air Force Auxiliary, and those with a contractual obligation to abide by the terms of Department of the Air Force (DAF) publications. Ensure all records generated as a result of processes prescribed in this publication adhere to Air Force Instruction (AFI) 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program,* and are disposed in accordance with the Air Force Records Disposition Schedule, which is located in the Air Force Records Information Management System.

Refer recommended changes, and questions about this publication to the office of primary responsibility (OPR) using the DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change Publication;* route DAF Forms 847 from the field through the appropriate functional chain of command. This DAFPD may not be supplemented.

SUMMARY OF CHANGES

This publication has been rewritten and should be reviewed in its entirety. Major changes include the merging of Air Force Policy Directive (AFPD) 16-13, *Survival, Evasion, Resistance, and Escape (SERE)* and AFPD 10-30, *Personnel Recovery,* and the updating of references to include current source information.

1. Overview. PR is the sum of military, diplomatic, and civil efforts to prepare for and execute the recovery and reintegration of isolated personnel (IP). IP are United States military, Department of Defense (DoD) civilians, and DoD contractor personnel authorized to accompany the Armed Forces of the United States (and others designated by the President or Secretary of Defense) who are separated from their unit or agency (as an individual or group) while participating in a US-sponsored military activity or mission and are, or may be, in a situation where they must survive, evade, resist, or escape. The four functions of PR are: preparation, planning, execution, and adaptation. The five PR execution tasks are: report, locate, support, recover, and reintegrate.

2. Policy. Preserving the lives, and well-being of DAF personnel placed in danger of being isolated, detained, captured, or having to evade while participating in a United States sponsored activity or mission is one of the highest priorities of the DAF.

2.1. The Air Force has the primary responsibility to recover DAF personnel who become isolated in an uncertain or hostile environment. They will maintain a global PR program to ensure Airmen and Guardians are trained in methods to prevent isolation and capture, and methods to survive, evade, resist, and escape in the event of isolation.

2.2. The DAF will train capable mission design series Aircrew and Air Force Special Warfare Airmen to execute the five PR tasks (report, locate, support, recover, and reintegrate). While the DAF may continue to organize, train, and equip to provide capability across the greater PR spectrum, the Air Force will prioritize providing a designated capability to meet the given changing and emerging threats faced by strategic competition. This capability will focus on a multi-layered (i.e., surface, air, space, and cyber domains) approach towards finding, fixing, tracking, and recovering isolated personnel. Efforts must be made to leverage emerging technologies (e.g., autonomous systems, small unmanned aerial systems, etc.), and surface maneuver elements to increase capacity and capability. The DAF forces will be trained and ready to integrate with joint forces, interagency, and multinational partners to effect recovery, however, are not postured to execute a PR Task Force unilaterally.

2.2.1. Preparation: Commanders and staff must be educated and trained to plan and implement the PR mission. Seamless execution of rescue missions necessitates peacetime integration of Air and Space Operations Center, and Joint Operations Center command and control functions in conjunction with designated and capable forces. Deploying DAF personnel will be trained in accordance with Department of Defense instructions and properly equipped to survive and evade for extended periods of time (i.e., greater than 72 hours) across all mission-relative environmental conditions as well as trained to utilize caches in support of future operating concepts and schemes of maneuver.

2.2.2. Planning: Major commands (MAJCOMs) and field commands (FLDCOMs) will ensure resources are provided to allow adequate PR planning capability with each other, joint forces, interagency, and multinational partners. Prior to the need to conduct coalition PR operations, Airmen and Guardians will work with host and partner nations to build partner capacity that spans the competition continuum. Component-Numbered Air Forces (C-NAFs) will ensure proper planning is conducted to identify all capable forces, command and control architecture, and authorities to support the recovery of DAF personnel.

2.2.3. Execution: The Air Force PR architecture will be effective in reporting incidents, locating, supporting, recovering, and reintegrating IP. Applicable MAJCOMs, FLDCOMs, and C-NAFs will ensure applicable PR coordination cells, PR centers, or capable PR nodes are adequately manned, trained, and equipped to meet or exceed all requirements in this paragraph. The C-NAF staff and applicable command and control cells must be prepared to plan, track and re-task capable forces to execute immediate or deliberate recovery of DAF personnel.

2.2.3.1. Report: Units, command posts, and PR coordination cells or PR centers will develop reporting procedures for overdue, missing, or isolated aircraft and personnel across the competition continuum.

2.2.3.2. Locate: Applicable MAJCOMs, FLDCOMs, and C-NAFs will ensure PR coordination cells or PR centers maintain command, control, communications, computers, intelligence, and reconnaissance systems to ascertain, and resolve the geo-location of reported IP locations to airborne and ground recovery forces. The terms and associated actions of find, fix, and track may be applied to the locate task for PR planning and execution.

2.2.3.3. Support: Applicable MAJCOMs, FLDCOMs, and C-NAFs will ensure PR coordination cells or PR centers have processes to help ensure the physical and psychological sustainment of the IP. This includes establishing two-way communication, situational awareness, morale, protection, resupply, directing to prepositioned caches, and support to the member's family.

2.2.3.4. Recovery: The Air Force will maintain properly equipped and sufficiently manned forces to execute recovery operations. This includes weapon systems procured, sustained, and managed that can execute PR across the competition continuum via the air and surface while leveraging multi-domain effects.

2.2.3.5. Reintegration: The Air Force has an obligation to reintegrate its IP and assist other Services as requested. The purpose of reintegration is to gather critical information from recovered persons while protecting their health and welfare and return capability to the service. When such individuals are returned to United States control, the Air Force will provide the appropriate and necessary measures to accomplish a successful reintegration that expeditiously returns the recovered person back to duty or society based on the recovered person's health, welfare, and isolating or captivity experience. This extends to the inclusion of the IP's family through the reintegration event, as applicable.

2.2.4. Adaptation: MAJCOMs and FLDCOMs will ensure all members with PR equity will study lessons learned to adapt operations and tactics, techniques, and procedures to better prepare capable forces, and to mitigate risk to recovery operations. The Joint Personnel Recovery Agency establishes and maintains the PR lessons learned and adaptation program through the Joint Lessons Learned Information System.

3. Responsibilities.

3.1. Office of the Secretary of the Air Force, Public Affairs (SAF/PA) will develop, coordinate, and oversee the implementation of Public Affairs plans and guidance for isolated/missing PR and reintegration events.

3.2. The Air Force Deputy Chief of Staff, Operations (AF/A3) develops and interprets PR policy, and will:

3.2.1. Develop and implement comprehensive strategies to address PR requirements for DAF personnel at risk of isolation and exploitation.

3.2.2. Provide oversight and approval of guidance pertaining to the minimum PR training for all DAF personnel employed throughout the competition continuum and across all geographic combatant commands, the training and employment of designated and capable forces to conduct PR operations, and coordination of mission essential tasks and measures to meet PR requirements.

3.2.3. Ensure PR, emergency beacon, and other emergency reporting devices' guidance complies with applicable DoD directives and instructions.

3.2.4. Maintain accountability for MAJCOM, FLDCOM, and C-NAF PR OPR contacts to promote efficient lines of communication.

3.2.5. Provide oversight for the Air Force SERE program to include establishing career developmental requirements, and identifying personnel requiring training, and formal training objectives.

3.2.6. Ensure guidance and procedures are in place to identify and track personnel who are SERE trained.

3.3. The Air Force Surgeon General (AF/SG) will:

3.3.1. In coordination with AF/A3, provide overall guidance and instruction on medical aspects of the reintegration process and augment the medical facilities at designated locations, as required, to support reintegration.

3.3.2. In coordination with AF/A3, develop requirements for Air Force SERE psychologists to support Air Force reintegration programs and Air Force SERE initial training units.

3.3.3. Provide subject matter experts to assist in the requirement to identify, certify, and train SERE psychologists.

3.4. The Deputy Chief of Staff, Manpower, Personnel and Services (AF/A1) will develop, coordinate and oversee the implementation of casualty reporting, notification, and assistance for isolated, captured, or missing DAF personnel, in support of their next of kin, throughout the personnel recovery and reintegration events. Additionally, the AF/A1 will coordinate with Space Force Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Human Capital (SF/S1), as required.

3.5. Headquarters Air Combat Command will:

3.5.1. Develop, program, and budget adequate funding for acquisition of PR capabilities, facilities, equipment, training, and personnel. Capabilities include items such as specialized PR survival equipment, life support equipment, command, control, communications, computers, intelligence, reconnaissance equipment, aircraft, and systems in aircraft, vehicles, and forces with PR applications. Coordinate with the United States Space Force for satellite capability requirements supporting the PR mission.

3.5.2. Develop standards and guidance for the interoperability of PR-related equipment across the MAJCOMs and FLDCOMs. Review capability development documents to ensure integration of PR capabilities into future acquisition programs.

3.5.3. Coordinate and support Air Force Futures (AF/A5/7) regarding the development of the PR capability development plans and other PR future operating concepts.

3.6. Headquarters Air Education and Training Command will coordinate with AF/A3 to develop training curriculum meeting DoD and Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff instructions to ensure PR training in Air Education and Training Command schools and that training locations meet warfighter requirements.

3.7. MAJCOMs, National Guard Bureau, FLDCOMs, field operating agencies, and direct reporting units will organize, train, and equip aircrew and other identified at-risk-of-isolation personnel for SERE operations, and develop, program, and budget adequate funding for facilities and equipment of their SERE programs.

3.8. All MAJCOMs, FLDCOMs, National Guard Bureau, and C-NAFs will establish and designate a command PR OPR and SERE program manager to coordinate with AF/A3 or A3 designated OPR on implementation of applicable PR policy and training of commanders, staffs, and potential IP.

3.9. DAF Component Commanders of the Combatant Commands will plan and execute DAF PR operations supporting DAF personnel within their area of responsibility and will establish and maintain an OPR for PR operations, training, doctrine, support, and execution. In addition, they will identify requirements and shortfalls for DAF PR capabilities within their combatant command component and coordinate resource requirements through the applicable commander.

GARY A. ASHWORTH
Acting Secretary of the Air Force

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

DoDD 3002.01, *Personnel Recovery in the Department of Defense,* 16 April 2009

DoDI 2310.05, *Accounting for Missing Persons – Boards of Inquiry,* 31 January 2000

DoDI 3002.02, *406 MHz Emergency Beacons and Other Emergency Reporting Devices in the Department of Defense in Support of Personnel Recovery and Search and Rescue*, 9 February 2023

DoDI 3002.03, *DoD Personnel Recovery – Reintegration of Recovered Personnel*, 15 July 2013

DoDI 3002.04, *DOD Personnel Recovery – Non-Conventional Assisted Recovery (NAR),* 17 November 2014

DoDI O-3002.05, *Personnel Recovery (PR) Education and Training,* 12 April 2016

DoDI 3003.01, *DoD Support to Civil Search and Rescue (SAR),* 26 September 2011

HAFMD 1-24, *Assistant Secretary of the Air Force, Manpower and Reserve Affairs*, 28 January 2019

HAFMD 1-54, *Deputy Chief of Staff, Operations,* 8 September 2015

JP 3-50, *Personnel Recovery*, 14 August 2023

AFI 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, 23 March 2020

Prescribed Forms

None

Adopted Forms

DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*

Abbreviations and Acronyms

AF—Air Force

AFI—Air Force Instruction

AFPD—Air Force Policy Directive

C-NAF—Component-Numbered Air Force

DAF—Department of the Air Force

DAFPD—Department of the Air Force Policy Directive

DoD—Department of Defense

DoDD—Department of Defense Directive

DoDI—Department of Defense Instruction

FLDCOM—Field Command

HAFMD—Headquarters Air Force Mission Directive

IP—Isolated Personnel

JP—Joint Publication

MAJCOM—Major Command

NAR—Non-Conventional Assisted Recovery

OPR—Office of Primary Responsibility

PR—Personnel Recovery

SAR—Search and Rescue

SERE—Survival, Evasion, Resistance, and Escape

Office Symbols

AF/A1—Air Force Deputy Chief of Staff, Manpower, Personnel and Services

AF/A3—Air Force Deputy Chief of Staff, Operations

AF/A3S—Air Force Special Warfare Directorate, Deputy Chief of Staff for Operations

AF/A5/7—Air Force Futures

AF/SG—Air Force Surgeon General

SAF/PA—Secretary of the Air Force, Public Affairs

SF/S1—Space Force Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Human Capital

USSF/COO—United States Space Force Chief Operations Officer

Terms

Competition Continuum—Rather than a world either at peace or at war, the competition continuum describes a world of enduring competition conducted through a mixture of cooperation, competition below armed conflict, and armed conflict.

Strategic Competition—The persistent and long-term interaction that occurs between relevant actors pursuing their interests across the competition continuum.

Mission Essential Tasks—Tasks deemed essential to mission accomplishment and defined using the common language of the Universal Joint Task List in terms of tasks, conditions, and standards. Service and interagency task lists augment the Universal Joint Task List to provide a comprehensive integrated menu of tasks, conditions, and standards, which include measures of effectiveness, and their associated criteria of performance that support all levels of the Department of Defense in executing the National Military Strategy across the competition continuum.